

Ben Banks

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I lead digital strategies which translate system complexity into clear and actionable steps. Nine years in digital and payments has taught me the best strategies are data-driven, clearly communicated, and built for execution — **most recently delivering \$5MM in annual savings at Blue Cross NC.**

WORK EXPERIENCE

Blue Cross NC 2022 – Present

Digital Payments Leader | Product Manager

- **\$5MM+ in recurring annual savings** achieved by consolidating vendor relationships by 75%, migrating members to lower-cost payment rails, and reducing inbound calls through improved self-service
- Define and execute the digital payments strategy and modernization roadmap for a **500k+ member population**
- Payments thought leader for emerging methods (RTP, FedNow) and their integration into member-facing experiences
- Directed delivery of an end-to-end, multi-tenant payments application, standardizing UX, processing rules, and business logic across **5+ digital channels**:
 - Led migration from a hosted payments page to a fully API-based integration model
 - Launched Apple Pay, Google Pay, PayPal, and Venmo via integrations with a best-in-class PSP
- Led payments BI strategy: authored SQL queries, built reporting frameworks, and tracked KPIs including payment adoption, cost per transaction, and success rates
- Launched two new payment channels: Guest Pay (no-login) and CSR Assisted Payments (agent-facilitated)
- Introduced targeted digital payment communications (decline notices, receipts) to reduce customer uncertainty and lower inbound payment-related calls
- Leveraged UX research — surveys, A/B testing, and interactive prototyping — to inform roadmap prioritization and UI design

Featurespace 2021 – 2022

Senior Product Manager, AI Payment Fraud Prevention

- Product strategy for ML/AI-powered financial crime prevention products
- Facilitated development of a new reporting suite for fraud analytics

First Citizens Bank 2017 – 2021

Product Manager, Commercial Digital Banking

- Assisted in the deployment and client migration to a new commercial digital banking platform
- Analyzed usage of treasury services including ACH, Wire, Positive Pay, and Bill Pay for commercial clients
- Led data projects to model pricing change impacts and develop customer migration strategies
- Tableau developer and data analyst using SQL, SAS, and DB Visualizer
- Cut data refresh times by 90% by building an automated data pipeline

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data & Analytics: SQL (advanced querying, joins, aggregations, views), Tableau, Power BI, Python (basic), SAS

Product & Delivery: KPI development, A/B testing, UX research, Jira, Confluence, agile delivery

Payments: ACH, RTP, FedNow, Cards, Digital Wallets (Apple Pay, Google Pay, PayPal, Venmo), PSP integrations, API-based payment architectures

EDUCATION & ACCOMPLISHMENTS

North Carolina State University — B.S. Finance, *Magna Cum Laude*

Eagle Scout | Base SAS Certified | AFP Digital Leadership | 2x Guest, CNBC *The Closing Bell*